



## Why connect

ChatGPT only knows what you paste into it or what it learned in training. It can't see what's actually happening in your deals. Once Backstory is connected, ChatGPT can:

- Look up any account and pull its status, open opportunities, and scorecards
- Summarize recent activity and show who's engaged on a deal
- Answer SalesAI questions and find comparable past deals with Situation Search

Reps ask ChatGPT about a deal and get an answer built on real activity data.

## At a glance

|                            |                                                                                                  |
|----------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Server URL                 | <a href="https://mcp.backstory.ai/mcp">https://mcp.backstory.ai/mcp</a>                          |
| Authentication             | OAuth 2.0, dynamic discovery                                                                     |
| What you configure by hand | Just the URL. No client IDs, secrets, or scopes.                                                 |
| Who signs in               | Each user, with their own Backstory login. Data is scoped to what the user can see in Backstory. |

**How auth works** Backstory MCP uses OAuth 2.0 with dynamic discovery. ChatGPT reads the authorization endpoints from the server itself, so there are no client IDs, secrets, or scopes to configure by hand. You sign in once and the app stays connected until you disconnect it.

## Before you start

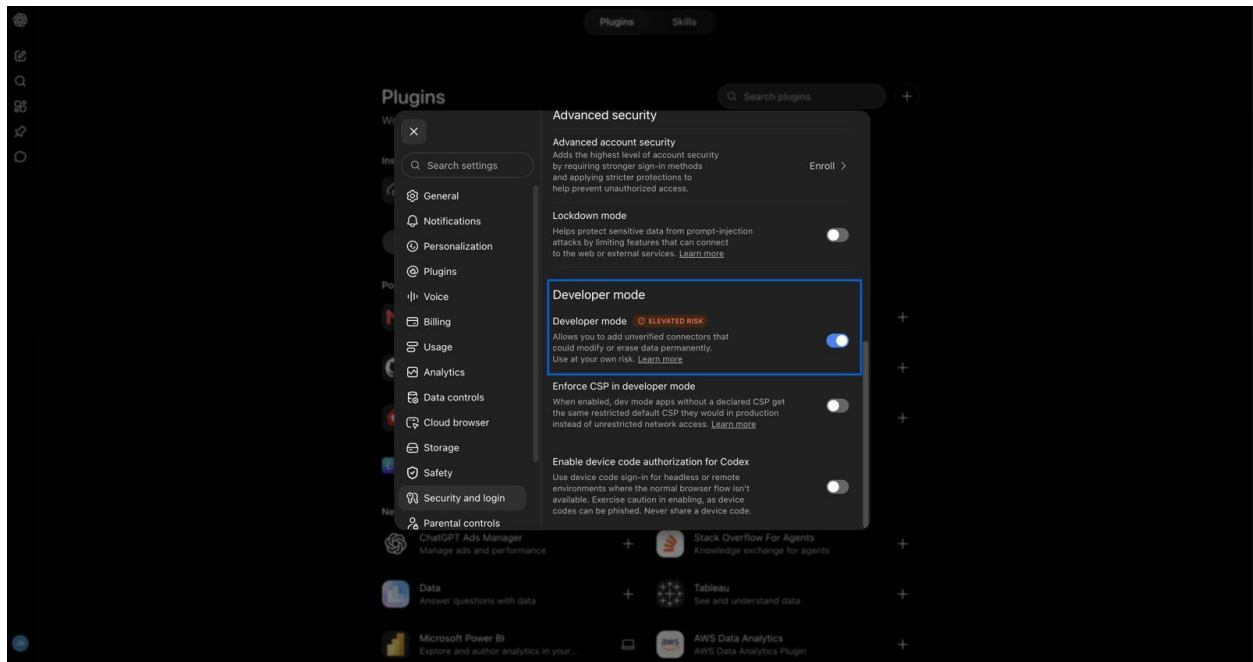
- A ChatGPT account on a paid plan that can use Developer mode (Plus or higher). Business and Enterprise workspaces may need an admin to allow custom apps.
- Your Backstory sign-in: your email and your company identification. The connection authenticates as you, so ChatGPT sees only the data your Backstory user can see.
- The MCP server URL below — the only value you have to paste.

**MCP server URL** <https://mcp.backstory.ai/mcp>

## The setup

### 1. Turn on Developer mode

In ChatGPT, open **Settings** and select **Security and login** in the left menu. Scroll to the **Developer mode** section and switch the **Developer mode** toggle on. Leave **Enforce CSP in developer mode** and **Enable device code authorization for Codex** off; neither is needed here.

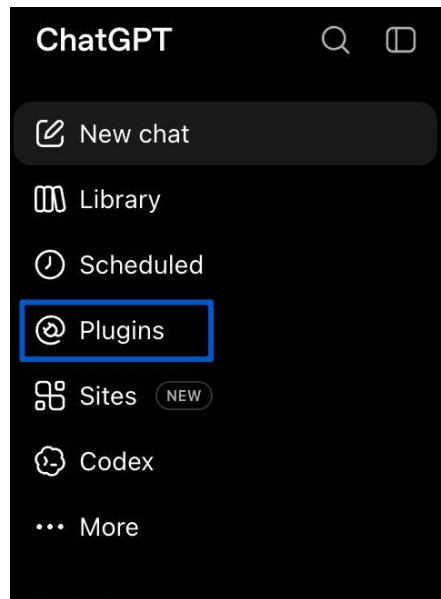


*Turn on Developer mode under Settings → Security and login*

**Elevated risk label** ChatGPT flags Developer mode because it allows unverified connectors. Backstory MCP is read-only, so it can't modify or erase data, but the warning applies to anything else you add while the toggle is on.

## 2. Open Plugins

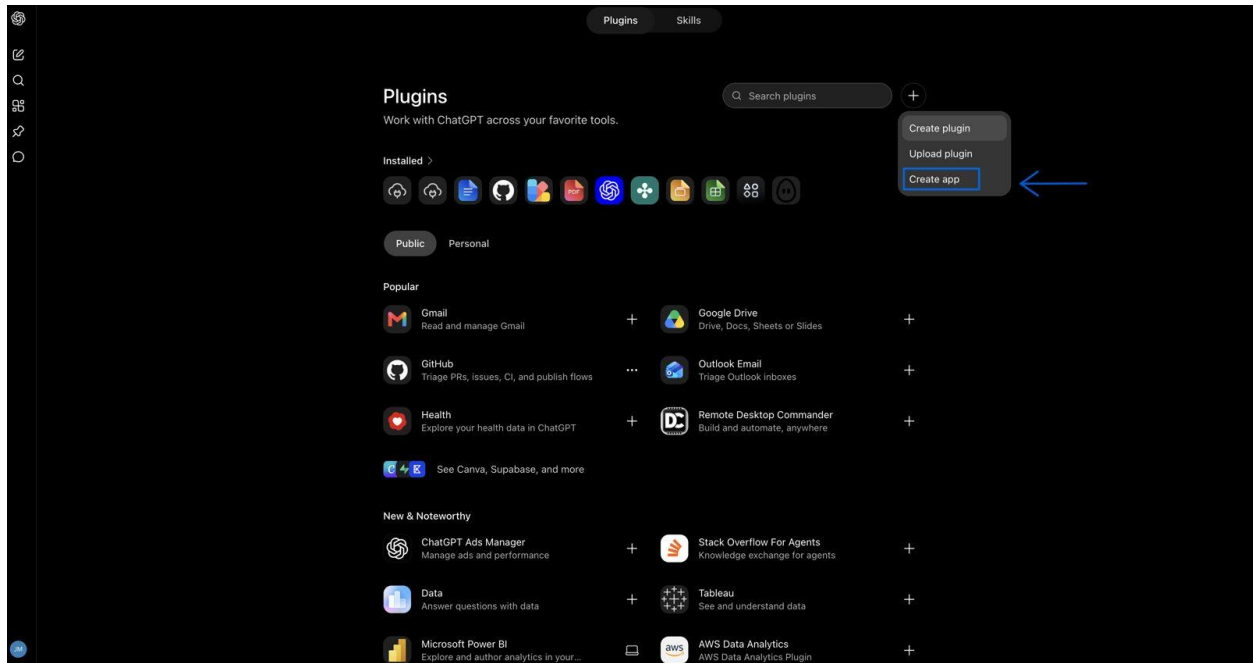
Close Settings and select **Plugins** in the left sidebar. This page replaced the old Apps & Connectors screen, so older guides that point to Settings → Connectors are out of date.



*Select Plugins in the left sidebar*

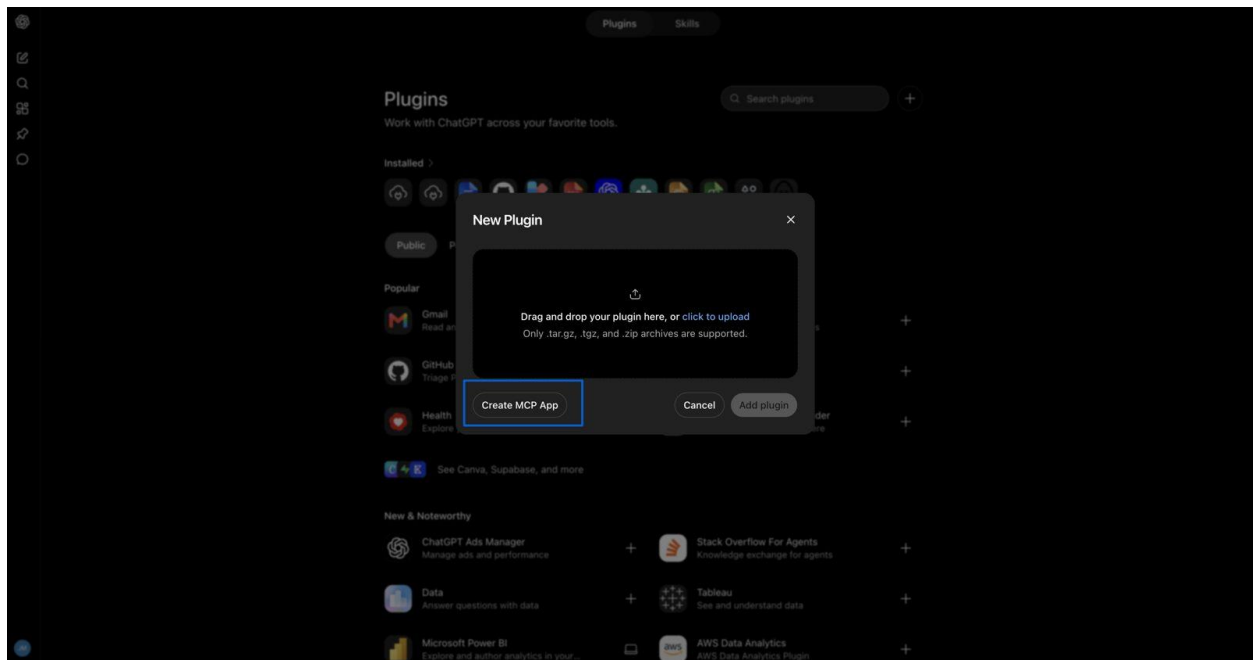
### 3. Select Create app

On the Plugins page, select the **+** to the right of the **Search plugins** box, then choose **Create app** from the menu. Skip **Create plugin** and **Upload plugin**; those are for packaged plugin archives, not a remote MCP server.



*Select + next to Search plugins, then Create app*

**Landed on New Plugin instead?** If you picked **Create plugin**, the New Plugin dialog asks for a .tar.gz or .zip archive. Don't upload anything; select **Create MCP App** in the bottom-left corner to reach the same form.



*From New Plugin, select Create MCP App*

4. Enter the server details

Fill in the new app form, then select **Create**:

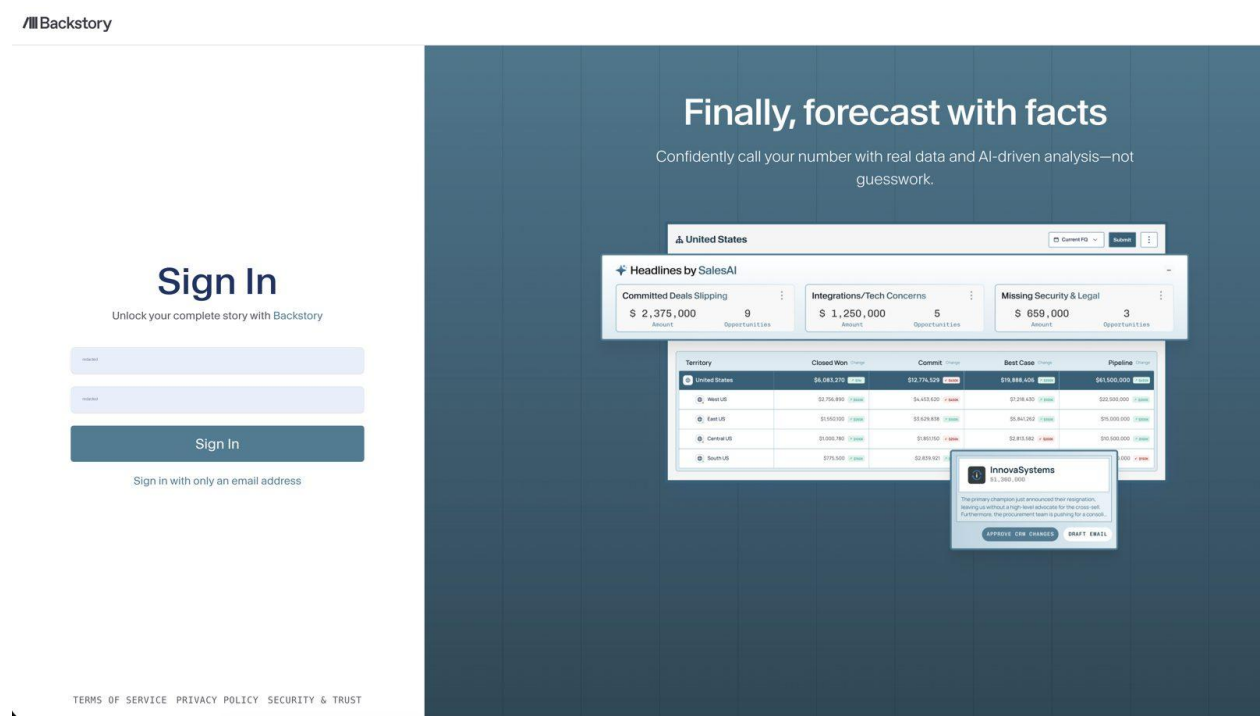
| Field                 | Value                                                                                                                                                                            |
|-----------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Name                  | Backstory MCP                                                                                                                                                                    |
| Description           | Account, opportunity, activity, engaged-people, and scorecard intelligence from Backstory. ChatGPT reads this text to decide when to call the app, so describe the data clearly. |
| MCP server URL        | https://mcp.backstory.ai/mcp                                                                                                                                                     |
| Authentication        | OAuth                                                                                                                                                                            |
| Trust acknowledgement | Check the box confirming you trust this server                                                                                                                                   |

**Name it clearly** A name like **Backstory MCP** is easy to find in the Plugins menu later.

**Watch the URL** The path matters: the URL ends in /mcp. A trailing slash or a missing path is the most common reason discovery fails and no tools appear.

5. Sign in to Backstory

ChatGPT opens a Backstory sign-in window. Enter your email and your company identification and select **Sign In**, or select **Sign in with only an email address** to get a link instead. The second field is the company ID, not a password. Approve the consent prompt if one appears; the window closes when authentication succeeds and the app shows as connected.

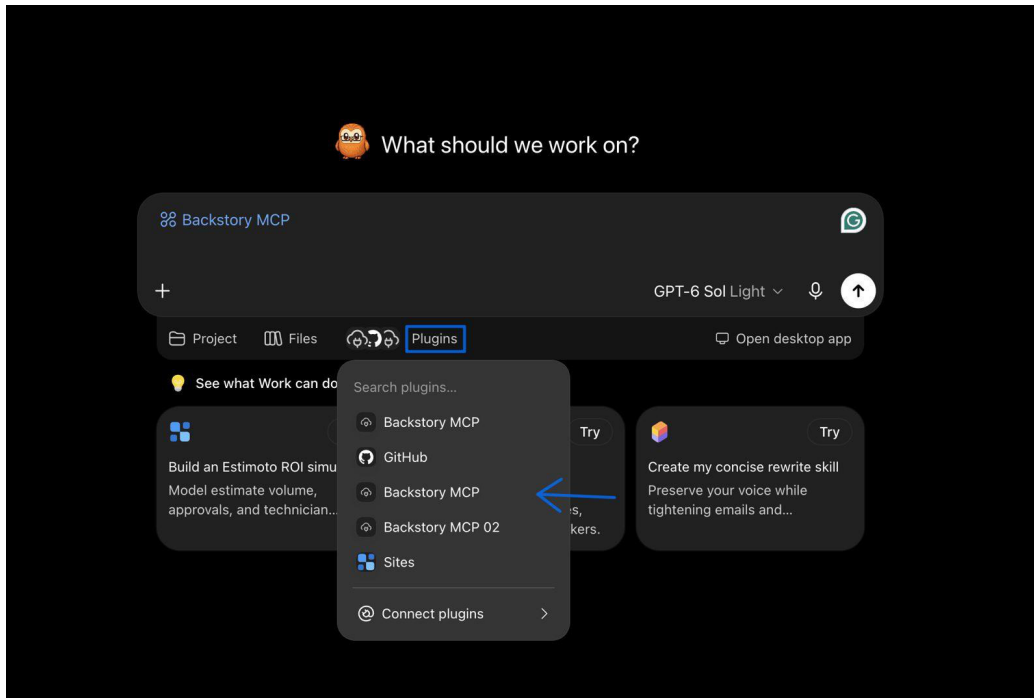


*Sign in with your email and company identification*

**Popups** If nothing happens after Create, the sign-in window was blocked. Allow popups for chatgpt.com and try again.

## 6. Add Backstory to a chat

Start a new chat and select **Plugins** in the bar under the message box. Pick **Backstory MCP** from the list; it appears as a chip at the top of the composer, which means ChatGPT will call it for this conversation.



*Select Plugins under the message box, then Backstory MCP*

**Several Backstory entries?** Pick the one you set up for your workspace. Each entry authenticates separately, so the data you see depends on which one you select.

## Verify

The app's tools are discovered automatically — account lookup, account and opportunity status, recent activity, engaged people, scorecards, Situation Search, and the SalesAI questions.

- Ask something that can only come from Backstory, such as “What’s the current status of [one of your accounts]?”
- Expand the tool call in the response to confirm ChatGPT called a Backstory tool rather than answering from general knowledge.
- The first call may ask you to confirm the action; approve it, and choose to always allow if you don’t want the prompt every time.

## Troubleshooting

**Can’t add the MCP server at all.** There’s no **Create app** option under **+**, or the form won’t save. Developer mode is off, or your workspace admin hasn’t allowed custom apps. Recheck Settings → Security and login; on Business or Enterprise, ask an admin to enable custom apps for the workspace.

**No tools listed after connecting.** Discovery didn’t complete. Check the URL ends in /mcp with no trailing slash, then delete the app and create it again.

**Sign-in window never opens.** Popups are blocked, or an earlier Backstory session in the same browser is interfering. Allow popups for chatgpt.com, or retry in a private window.

**ChatGPT answers without calling Backstory.** The app isn't selected for this chat, or the prompt is too generic. Confirm the Backstory chip is in the composer and name Backstory or a specific account in the question.

**Wrong or empty data.** Results are scoped to the Backstory user who authenticated. Confirm you picked the right Backstory entry and signed in with the right company identification.

**Need to reconnect.** Open **Plugins → Installed**, select the Backstory app, and disconnect. Selecting it again in a chat restarts the sign-in.